

Sector Brief

SNAPSHOT

EDUCATION · EDTECH · SKILLING · WORKFORCE

Week of 13 July 2026 | 15 stories | 9 countries

This week in brief. Healthcare-workforce strain surfaced from Manila to Bangkok to Bengaluru: a remote-nursing boom is feeding Filipino talent into US hospitals while emptying local wards, Thailand exempted frontline health workers from civil-service cuts, and Narayana Health promoted nurses into hospital management via a fully sponsored IIM Bangalore programme. AI anxiety and skilling policy moved in parallel — Vietnam's top leader ordered a national pivot to a high-quality workforce, Indonesia set out to train 361,000 teachers in coding and AI, and nearly half of Singapore's workforce told surveyors they fear their jobs are next. In Washington, federal loan caps threaten to squeeze the school-principal pipeline even as the Department of Labor poured \$162 million into industrial apprenticeships.

INDIA

VIETNAM

PHILIPPINES

THAILAND

SINGAPORE

INDONESIA

SOUTH KOREA

JAPAN

USA

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INDIA

Narayana Health hands hospital management to nurses, not administrators

Narayana Health founder Dr Devi Shetty is opening a nurse-run "smart" hospital in Bengaluru's Banashankari, where 25 nurses will manage operations while keeping their clinical duties and pay. Selected nurses will complete a fully sponsored Executive Programme in Hospital Administration at IIM Bangalore.

India Today · 2026-07-06

HUL and Dabur trim headcount even as median pay jumps

FY26 filings show Hindustan Unilever cut more than 700 permanent staff and Dabur more than 500, even as median employee pay rose 6.08% and 7.7% respectively — a divergence executives attribute to automation and AI-driven analytics in manufacturing and supply chains. Nestlé India, Marico and Tata Consumer Products expanded headcount over the same period, with TCPL posting the sector's sharpest pay rise at 12.1%.

Rediff.com Business · 2026-07-12

VIETNAM

Samsung deepens Vietnam's semiconductor talent pipeline with new university deals

Samsung is expanding its Innovation Campus programme in Vietnam and signed a 2026-2028 cooperation deal with three Hanoi universities covering scholarships, research and recruitment, part of a plan to train over 2,200 students this year across roughly 20 partner institutions. The push backs Vietnam's target of 50,000 semiconductor engineers by 2030 and includes about VND17 billion (~\$650,000) in new scholarships.

VietnamPlus (Vietnam News Agency) · 2026-07-10

Vietnam's top leader orders a national pivot to skilled labour

Party chief and President To Lam called for Vietnam to build an integrated national labour-market information system and shift the economy from low-cost labour toward a high-quality, digitally- and green-skilled workforce. He directed the government to draft a national workforce and labour-market development plan addressing shortages in vocational, digital and technical skills.

Vietnam News · 2026-07-08

PHILIPPINES

Philippine remote nurses staff US hospitals as home shortage deepens

US hospitals facing a shortfall of nearly 80,000 registered nurses are increasingly hiring Filipino remote workers to monitor ICU patients for \$5-10 an hour, versus \$45-plus for US-based RNs. The Philippines' outsourced health sector employed about 210,000 people in 2025 generating \$4.5 billion in revenue, with roughly 30% in nursing or medical roles — even as critics warn the trend worsens the country's own 190,000-worker health staffing gap.

Rest of World · 2026-07-09

Manila ties wage growth to a national upskilling push

The Marcos administration framed workforce upskilling as central to raising wages, citing expanded "Trabaho Agad" job fairs, a Labor Education for Graduating Students programme and a deepened DOLE-TESDA training partnership. The push comes against roughly 2.5 million jobless Filipinos as of May and youth labour-force participation of just 32.3%.

BusinessWorld Online · 2026-07-09

THAILAND

Thailand exempts frontline health workers from civil-service cuts

Thailand's Ministry of Public Health backed the government's broader early-retirement and workforce-reduction drive but is seeking to exempt frontline doctors and nurses, citing chronic clinical shortages. The ministry estimates it still needs about 90,000 additional healthcare posts and has already hired more than 30,000 workers using its own revenue.

Bangkok Post · 2026-07-09

SINGAPORE

Singapore's palliative-care nurse training outpaces its own 2030 target

Health Minister Ong Ye Kung said the Nursing Home-Nursing Professional Development Workgroup, formed in January 2026, is training generalist palliative-care nurses faster than expected, with National University Hospital alone targeting 3,100 nurses against a national goal of 10,000 by 2030. Several public healthcare institutions have set up in-house training in end-of-life care and advance care planning for nursing-home staff.

The Straits Times · 2026-07-06

Job insecurity from AI hits half of Singapore's workforce

Morgan McKinley's 2026 Workplace Trends Report found 49% of employees in Singapore expect their roles affected by restructuring, automation or cost-cutting this year, well above the 37% global average, as Ministry of Manpower data showed retrenchments at their highest quarterly level since 2023. Globally, 64% of workers who feared job loss said they planned to invest in new skills or qualifications to stay employable.

Vulcan Post · 2026-07-10

INDONESIA

Jakarta sets out to train 361,000 teachers in AI and coding

Indonesia's Ministry of Primary and Secondary Education launched a self-directed training programme aiming to train more than 361,000 teachers and education staff in deep learning, coding and AI during 2026, building on 2025 results that reached 97% of its coding/AI school target. The rollout uses existing Teacher Working Groups and Subject-Matter Teacher Forums to deliver training regionally.

ANTARA News · 2026-07-10

SOUTH KOREA

Daekyo swaps a shrinking hagwon base for global AI-led learning

Marking its 50th anniversary, Korean tutoring group Daekyo is accelerating overseas expansion of its Eye Level and TuniTuni brands, now running more than 1,500 learning centres across roughly 20 countries and serving over a million members annually. Domestically, Daekyo has layered AI-based analytics into its personalised learning system and moved into senior care through subsidiary Daekyo Newif.

The Korea Times · 2026-07-08

JAPAN

Seven in ten Japanese hotels report a staffing shortage

A government tourism white paper found 72.2% of 522 surveyed accommodation facilities reported labour shortages, with midsize properties hit hardest at 77.1%. The report cited low pay and lack of days off as deterrents to hospitality jobs, and called for higher wages, more foreign and part-time hiring, and greater investment in automation.

The Japan Times · 2026-07-10

Tokyo lets universities pool investments as smaller schools struggle

Japan's government is preparing to let national universities jointly invest in stocks, real estate and other assets, giving smaller schools a way to build endowments as enrolment falls. The move is framed as a cushion against demographic decline and inflation pressure on institutional budgets.

Nikkei Asia · 2026-07-12

USA

Federal loan caps threaten to shrink America's principal pipeline

A new Arizona State University working paper finds that federal graduate-loan borrowing caps under the One Big Beautiful Bill Act will hit aspiring principals and superintendents hardest, since most education-leadership degrees were excluded from the expanded "professional degree" list. Licensure typically requires a master's degree plus 30-45 additional credit hours, pushing borrowing needs close to or above the new \$100,000 lifetime cap — and about 45% of superintendents hold a doctorate.

Education Week · 2026-07-09

Washington bets \$162 million on outcomes-based apprenticeships

The US Department of Labor awarded nearly \$162 million across five cooperative agreements to expand Registered Apprenticeships in shipbuilding, defence manufacturing, AI infrastructure, semiconductors, nuclear energy, telecoms, IT and automotive service — recipients include Jobs for the Future (\$40M) and FloridaCommerce (\$40M). Payments are tied to verified apprentice retention and progression milestones rather than upfront enrolment.

U.S. Department of Labor · 2026-07-07

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